

Acids

When bonded to hydrogen, the halogens form mostly strong acids. These compounds can react with many materials, even unreactive elements such as gold. Mixing a halogen acid and a metal produces a salt and pure hydrogen gas.

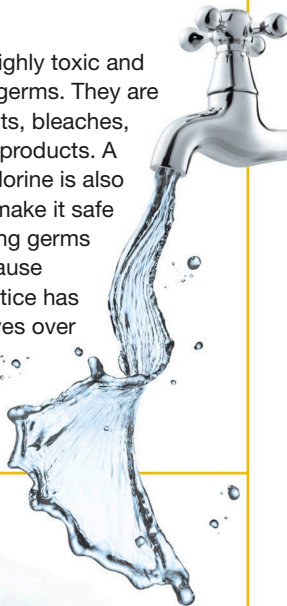
Hydrochloric acid is added to zinc nuggets



Cleaners

The halogens are highly toxic and can be used to kill germs. They are present in detergents, bleaches, and other cleaning products. A small amount of chlorine is also added to water to make it safe for drinking, by killing germs present that may cause diseases. This practice has saved millions of lives over the last century.

Tap water treated with chlorine



Kelp, found underwater, is a source of iodine

